

Dataset: Bulgaria
Analyses: First Draft of Indices

1. Government Priority

4. Fighting crime as such is important, but in your opinion which should be the government's highest priority? And which should be the government's next highest priority? (Ranking question, respondents ranked two of three)
1/ Fighting petty, everyday crime /theft, robbery/
2/ Fighting organized crime /drug dealing, organized crime groupings/
3/ Fighting economic crime /corruption, illegal privatization, etc./

2. Attitude toward Crime

5. In your opinion, how likely is each of the following to happen? (Scale: 1-5, 5 = very likely)
A. Risk of crime against you and your property
1/ Your home to be burgled and your property stolen
2/ You or a member of your family to become a victim of an assault
B. Probability for justice against the offender
3/ If you become a victim of a crime, the offender will be caught
4/ The offender will be convicted in court

28. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement regarding the crime situation in our country? (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)
2/ Society is also responsible for the fact that some people become criminals. (T1:Q25_8 – The social conditions in Bulgaria make people commit crimes.)
3/ The jails in Bulgaria are overcrowded. (T1:Q25_2)
4/ The sustenance of a prisoner is a very heavy financial burden on the state. (T1:Q25_3 – Keeping a prisoner in prison costs too much to the taxpayer.)
5/ The stay in jail causes a positive transformation in the offenders. (T1:Q25_4 – The prison term changes the offender for the better.)
6/ The Court releases a large number of the arrested offenders without reasonable argumentation. (T1:Q25_5)
7/ The police often arrests people without evidence that they have committed a crime (T1:Q25_1)
8/ In Bulgaria all people are equal against the law. (T1:Q25_9 – Everybody in Bulgaria is equal before the law.)
T1: Q25_6 – The most serious obstacle to convicting the offenders is insufficient evidence
T1:Q25_7 – The prosecution does not exert sufficient control over the investigation.

29. In your opinion, the government's overall policy for fighting crime is heading in the right or wrong direction? (T1: Q28)	
1/ Entirely right	1
2/ Right	2
3/ Wrong	3
4/ Entirely wrong	4
99/ Can't say	99

3. Combating Crime

8. Different measures for combating crime have been discussed lately. In your opinion how efficient will any of the listed below be? (Scale: 1-5, 5 = very efficient)
1/ Programs for reducing poverty and unemployment
2/ More prevention and community service for juveniles instead of prison sentences
3/ Introducing tougher custody measures for defendants even for smaller crimes
4/ Restoring the death penalty
5/ Tougher sentences for all offenders
T1: Q8_6 – Tougher sentences for juvenile offenders
6/ Showing less violence in the media
7/ Programs for re-socialization of prisoners who have served their terms in jail
8/ Restriction of the rights of certain groups exhibiting criminal behavior
9/ More discipline in the family and in schools
10/ Speedier trials following a simplified procedure

4. Drug Trafficking

9. To what extent would you say drug trafficking and dealing affect the crime rate in Bulgaria?
1/ To a great extent
2/ To some extent
3/ To a minor extent
4/ Not at all
99/ Can't say

5. Drug Legalization

10. The experts have different opinions with regards the legalization of certain drugs in order to reduce some crimes? How strongly do you agree or disagree with the following ideas? (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)
1/ The so called "soft" drugs like cannabis should be legalized and sold at special places
2/ Hard drugs like heroin should be legalized and sold at special places
3/ There should be penalties not only for drug dealing, but also for drug taking
4/ More resources need to be allocated for breaking the network of the drug traffic

6. Youth Drug Users

11. Which of the following two statements would you support? First: More resources need to be allocated for treatment of young drug users Second: More resources need to be allocated for a firm fight against drugs including detaining young drug users Answer Options: First, First rather than Second, Both, Second rather than First, Second, DK
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7. Attitude toward Legal System

17. Which of the following two positions do you support? (T1:Q16)

First: If people are allowed to take the law in their hands that would make the legal system more efficient. Second: If people start administering justice themselves, there will be chaos in the country and no one could feel safe.

Answer Options: First, First rather than Second, Both, Second rather than First, Second, DK

23. There are different opinions on the problems with the law enforcement system in Bulgaria. Which is closest to yours? (T1:Q21)

1/ The system is good, the problem is with the individual people working in it and not performing their duties	1
2/ People need not be changed. What is necessary is institutional changes in the powers of the different branches in the justice system.	2

24. One of the issues much debated recently is the place of the investigation service with a view of increasing the efficiency of preliminary investigation. In your opinion: (T1:Q22)

1/ <i>It is better if the Investigation service is within the Ministry of Interior so that there is better coordination between the police and the investigation</i>	1
2/ It is better if the Investigation service remains independent to create guarantees for unbiased operation taking into account the interest of both the defendants and the public.	2

25. Another controversial issue being debated lately is the place of the prosecution. Which of the following opinions is closest to yours? (T1:Q23)

1/ The Prosecution should be part of the executive branch	1
2/ <i>The Prosecution should remain as it is now – part of the judicial branch</i>	2
3/ The Prosecution should be accountable to Parliament	3

8. Custody

15. And now I would like to ask you about your opinion regarding the custody measures. (T1:Q14s) (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)

1/ Keeping more defendants in custody reduces the number of crimes.
2/ Keeping a defendant in custody is not a guarantee that the defendant will be convicted, it may even be an obstacle.
3/ Softer custody restriction for first time offenders or juveniles encourages criminals to commit more crimes.
4/ People should be kept in detention only as a last resort because the stay in prison only breeds hatred and could make them hardened criminals.

9. Reducing Crime

16. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following ideas for reducing crime? (T1:Q15s) (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)

1/ Keep defendants in detention even when they are not proven guilty
2/ The laws and courts should be less on the side of the defendants
3/ Defendants should not be treated as innocent until proven guilty
4/ A confession should not be deemed as evidence of guilt

5/ The laws and regulations regarding collection of evidence should be strictly observed even if that would take more time.
T1:Q15_6 – A constitutional amendment needs to be passed to make the law enforcement more ...

10. Resources

16A. Many sectors of the state need to be funded and this is why allocating additional funds should be done very carefully. In your opinion, if the government has to choose, which of the following activities should be funded even if that would mean fewer resources for other sectors? /Circle the number of the three most important activities/ (T1:Q13s)	
1/ Technical equipment for the police – cars, choppers, etc.	1
2/ More weapons for the police	2
3/ Surveillance and undercover measures	3
4/ For the Investigation so that it will be able to quickly investigate crimes	4
5/ For the economic and financial police who investigate big financial fraud	5
6/ For more patrolling policemen	6
7/ For the courts to assure speedier trials	7
8/ For breaking the drug production and dealing networks	8
9/ For increasing the capacity of prisons	9

11. Police Violence

18. One of the issues which is frequently debated is the powers of the police and to what extent is police violence justified. (T1:Q17s) (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)	
1/ The police should sometimes be able to resort to violence to get a conviction and punish the suspected criminal	
3/ Violence is acceptable only if it results in a confession by the offenders	
4/ Every citizen, including the offender, has rights and the police has to observe those rights	
5/ If someone has broken the law, the police does not have to observe his/her rights	

19/ How much do you agree with the following opinion – More powers to the police to detain and question suspects will result in significant improvement in the fight against crime. (T1:Q18)	
1/ Strongly agree	1
2/ Somewhat agree	2
3/ Somewhat disagree	3
4/ Strongly disagree	4
5/ Can't say	99

12. Death Penalty

20. How much do you agree or disagree that the death penalty is the only appropriate punishment for certain types of crime? (T1:Q19)	
1/ Strongly agree	1
2/ Somewhat agree	2
3/ Somewhat disagree	3

4/ Strongly disagree	4
99/ Can't say	99

21. All systems of justice make mistakes, but still, which of the following do you think is worse? (T1: Q20)

First: It is worse to convict an innocent man

Second: It is worse to let a guilty person go free

Answer Options: First, First rather than Second, Both, Second rather than First, Second, DK

13. Attitude toward people's rights (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)

Q26_1: Law needs to be observed even if you do not agree with it

Q26_2: The judgment about right and wrong depends on the situation

Q26_3: People do what they consider right even if the others do not agree with them

Q26_4: People should learn to cope on their own and not rely on other people

Q26_5: People have the right to use violence if forced to

14. Role of the Media

27. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following ideas regarding the [media's](#) role in the fight against crime? (T1:Q24s) (Scale: 1-5, 5 = strongly agree)

1/ Media should provide information even about the most heinous of crimes

2/ Violence shown by the media triggers off similar behavior in young people and children.

3/ The media should carefully check their stories before publishing even if that takes more time.

4/ It is more important for the media to provide quick information even if that would mean not getting some of the facts right